

The \$500/Day Plan

A 4-Account Structured Trading Experiment on the NOVA Terminal Platform — Rules, Risk Framework & the Honest Path to \$500/Day

Executive summary. The goal is a consistent **\$500 trading day**. This plan runs **four accounts in parallel** — one real (\$5,000) and three paper (\$10,000 / \$15,000 / \$25,000) — for **30 trading days** on the NOVA Terminal platform, all using the same verified signal engine (60.9% win rate, 2.2% max drawdown on a 550-day backtest) and the same risk rules. The experiment proves, with real numbers, **which capital level supports \$500/day** — and builds the discipline record to scale the real account to that level. No promises, no shortcuts: professional process only.

1. First, The Honest Math (Read Before Anything Else)

"\$500 per day" means something very different on each account:

Account	Capital	\$500/day =	Annualized (21 trading days/mo, no compounding)	Professional verdict
Real	\$5,000	10% / day	~2,500% / year	Not sustainable — no consistent trader in history does this. Chasing it = account blow-up.
Paper 1	\$10,000	5% / day	~1,250% / year	Not sustainable.
Paper 2	\$15,000	3.3% / day	~830% / year	Possible on the best single days; not repeatable daily.
Paper 3	\$25,000	2% / day	~500% / year	Aggressive but professional stretch-target on active days. This is the account where \$500/day becomes a real, testable goal.

Benchmark reality: the world's best hedge funds average 20–40% per *year*. Elite day traders have 5–15% *months*. Anyone promising a fixed 10% per day is lying. Our edge is different: a **verified signal engine + iron risk discipline + honest tracking** — that's what compounds an account to the size where \$500/day is normal.

US PDT rule (critical, applies to real money): a margin account below **\$25,000** is limited to **3 day-trades per 5 business days** (FINRA Pattern Day Trader rule). Consequence: the \$5k/\$10k/\$15k accounts must trade **swing style** (hold 1–12 days — exactly what our signal engine is built for). Unlimited day trading only becomes legal at \$25,000+. This alone dictates the structure below.

2. The Four Accounts — Roles & Realistic Targets

Account	Style (PDT-compliant)	Daily target band	Daily LOSS limit (hard stop)	Role in the experiment
Real • \$5,000	Swing — engine signals only	\$50–100 avg (1–2%)	–\$100 (2%) → stop for the day	Real-money discipline; proves the process with skin in the game
Paper • \$10,000	Swing — engine signals only	\$100–200	–\$200	Same strategy, 2× capital: shows how P&L scales with size, not risk
Paper • \$15,000	Swing + inverse-ETF shorts	\$150–300	–\$300	Adds the short side: tests both-direction performance
Paper • \$25,000	Swing + intraday (PDT-free)	\$250–500 • the \$500/day lab	–\$500 (2%)	The main event: can disciplined trading at 2%/day stretch produce \$500 days?

The key insight this table teaches the client: the same skill and the same strategy produce \$100 on \$5k and \$500 on \$25k. **\$500/day is a capital question, not a magic-strategy question.** The experiment proves the process; capital scaling delivers the number.

3. The Strategy (What Actually Gets Traded)

3.1 Primary: NOVA AI signals (the M-config engine)

- **What it is:** the platform's strict 5-gate signal engine — score ≥ 70 , RSI/ADX/volume filters, SPY market-regime gate, verified 550-day backtest: **60.9% win rate, profit factor 1.12, max drawdown 2.2%, max 2 consecutive losses**.
- **Entry:** only when an alert appears (expect ~3–5/month — rare by design). Tap **Buy** → the popup pre-fills entry, quantity (1% risk), trailing stop, target. Confirm. Done.
- **Exit:** automatic — trailing stop locks profit, take-profit banks the win, stop-loss caps the loss at ~1% of account. Never remove a stop. Never average down.
- **Expected math per signal:** risk 1% → average win $\approx +0.7R$, average loss $\approx -1R$, 6 wins per 10 decided trades.

3.2 Secondary: inverse-ETF shorts (down days)

- When the market is red, the platform's Short-side section activates (SH/PSQ/SQQQ etc. with live ACTIVE badges). Buying an inverse ETF profits from the fall — same 1%-risk popup, same trailing stop.
- This keeps all four accounts productive in down markets instead of forcing bad longs.

3.3 The \$25k account's extra tool: disciplined intraday

- Above \$25k the PDT rule disappears — the account may day-trade liquid large-caps (AAPL/NVDA/TSLA tier) at the open (9:30–11:00 ET), 0.5% risk per trade, max 3 intraday trades/day, done by noon.
- 2 winners at ~1R on 0.5% risk $\approx$ \$250; a signal-trade win on top reaches the \$500 band. **That is the honest anatomy of a \$500 day.**

4. Iron Risk Rules (Non-Negotiable — All 4 Accounts)

1. **Risk per trade: 1%** of account (0.5% intraday). The platform popup sizes this automatically.
2. **Daily loss limit: 2%** → hit it and STOP for the day. No exceptions, no "one more trade". Tomorrow exists.
3. **Weekly loss limit: 5%** → stop for the week. Review the journal, not the market.
4. **Max 3 open positions** per account at once (correlation kills small accounts).
5. **Every trade has a stop BEFORE entry** — the popup enforces it. Removing a stop = breaking the experiment.
6. **No revenge trading, no averaging down, no news-gambling** (skip entries the day before earnings).
7. **No signal = no trade.** Cash is a position. The engine's silence in weak markets IS the edge.
8. **Log everything** — the platform's History & Analysis pages do it automatically; review every Sunday.

5. Daily Routine (US Market, ~90 Minutes of Attention)

Time (ET)	Time (IST)	Action
9:00–9:30	6:30–7:00 PM	Open NOVA → check Market Mood (SPY/QQQ), regime status, any overnight alerts, positions & stops
9:30–11:00	7:00–8:30 PM	Active window: act on alerts (all accounts); \$25k account may take up to 3 intraday setups; place brackets, walk away
11:00–15:30	8:30 PM–1:00 AM	Hands off — trailing stops manage everything. Optional one check at lunch. No boredom trades.
15:30–16:00	1:00–1:30 AM	Close-check: intraday positions flat by 15:55 on the \$25k account; swings stay with their stops
Weekend	—	Sunday review: Analysis page per account — win rate, avg R, drawdown, rule violations (target: zero)

6. The 30-Day Experiment Protocol

1. **Days 1–10:** all four accounts trade identically (signals + inverse ETFs). Goal: zero rule violations. P&L is secondary — process first.
2. **Days 11–20:** \$25k paper adds the intraday module. Compare: does it add profit or just noise? The other three continue unchanged.
3. **Days 21–30:** full system. Each account graded on: total P&L, win rate, max drawdown, rule violations, \$500-days achieved (the \$25k lab).
4. **Scorecard verdict:** if the \$25k paper account shows positive expectancy and hits \$250–500 days with $\leq 2\%$ drawdowns → the plan is proven → scale the REAL account toward \$25k (deposits + compounded profits) and repeat live. If it fails → we know before real money was risked. Either result is a win.

What the paper accounts are really for: they are the laboratory. Identical strategy at 3 capital levels isolates ONE variable — capital — and proves to the client, with the platform's own Analysis page, that process + capital = the \$500 day. Paper results carry zero market risk and cost nothing.

7. Risk Factors (Full Disclosure)

Risk	Reality	Control in this plan
Market risk	Any trade can lose; losing streaks happen even at 60% win rate (2–3 in a row is normal)	1% sizing → a 5-loss streak costs ~5%, fully recoverable
Gap risk	Overnight news can jump a stock past your stop	No entries before earnings; position sizes keep worst-case gaps survivable
Backtest ≠ future	60.9% is history (61 trades); live results WILL vary	Paper-first proof; monthly re-verification of the engine's live Reality-Check stats
PDT violations	4th day-trade in 5 days on a <\$25k margin account = 90-day freeze	Small accounts are swing-only by design
Commissions/slippage	~\$1/order eats small trades; paper fills are kinder than real fills	Min trade size ~\$500; expect real results ~10–15% below paper
Psychology (the #1 killer)	Revenge trading and target-chasing destroy more accounts than bad strategies	Daily loss limit + "no signal = no trade" + automatic journaling; a missed day is \$0, a broken rule is a failed experiment
Platform/connectivity	Gateway session expiry, internet outage	Every position always has a server-side stop at IBKR — protection works even with the app closed

Required disclosure: trading involves substantial risk of loss and is not suitable for everyone. Past performance (including the platform's backtest) does not guarantee future results. Never trade money you cannot afford to lose. This plan is an educational framework, not investment advice; the trader confirms and owns every order.

8. What Success Looks Like (90-Day View)

Milestone	Measure
Month 1	30-day experiment complete · zero rule violations · \$25k lab hits ≥5 days of \$250+ · real \$5k account positive with ≤3% drawdown
Month 2	Real account scaled (deposit/compound) toward \$15–25k · repeat proven playbook live · first real \$250+ days
Month 3	Real account ≥\$25k · intraday module unlocked live · \$500 days become a normal outcome of a 2% stretch-target process — not a gamble

The one-line philosophy: we don't chase \$500/day — we build the account and the discipline where \$500/day is just 2%. The platform (signals, auto-sizing, trailing stops, honest analytics) exists precisely to make that process repeatable.

Prepared July 2026 by Technova Technologies · NOVA Terminal (nassphx.com) · Educational framework — not investment advice · Trading involves substantial risk of loss · Past performance does not guarantee future results.